An hour later, I repeated the same routine and managed to sneak safely back to my room. Another hour later – really enjoying myself by this stage – I set off again, turned on the TV and rushed back to my room.

The next morning at breakfast, I was sitting quietly when Graeme spoke up.

'I swear there's a ghost in my room,' he said, telling us how his television had kept turning itself on the previous night and how he had to keep getting up to turn it off. I could not resist repeating the entire procedure that night, but enough was enough, and the identity of the 'ghost' was eventually revealed.

In my opinion, Jacques Kallis is the greatest Test cricketer of all time. In the entire history of our game, there has never been a player who has remotely matched his achievements.

'Jakes' could run in, bowl at 140 kilometres per hour, and produce great deliveries to dismiss great batsmen at crucial moments in the game, and then he would go out and score 150 runs. Nobody else has ever done that. He was so much more than just an outstanding jack-of-all-trades all-rounder ... he was a frontline bowler as well as a frontline batsman, and he was an exceptional slip fielder, too, with brilliant hands and movement.

The statistics leave no room for discussion.

Longevity? He played in 166 Test matches between 1995 and 2013, a career spanning 18 years. Batting? He scored 13 289 runs in Tests, including 45 centuries and 58 half-centuries; only Sachin Tendulkar and Ricky Ponting have scored more runs. Bowling? He took 292 Test wickets in 3 372 overs, ranking 29th in the list of all-time wicket takers. Fielding? He held precisely 200 catches in Test matches.

Consider that, in addition to these feats, he scored another 11 579 runs and claimed another 273 wickets in 328 one-day internationals, plus another 666 runs and 12 wickets in 25 T20 internationals, and it becomes abundantly clear why, for so many of us who played alongside